

Oil prices will fall even if Hormuz traffic only partially recovers

送信者: EG Energy, Climate & Resources 受信日時: 2026-08-14 02:26

【メール原文】

Crude prices will likely fall as the US and Iran pursue de-escalation . A deal between Iran and the US that would reopen the Strait of Hormuz on an in||||||||||||

Energy, Climate & Resources

[Customize Email Preferences](#)

Oil prices will fall even if Hormuz traffic only partially recovers

13 Aug 2026 13:21 EDT [Discover more on the Portal](#)

*

US-Iranian de-escalation in September will allow for a partial reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, with prices falling into a \$65-80 band for the rest of the year.

*

Even if strait traffic doesn't recover past 30-50% of its prewar level, the flow of oil is likely to be sufficient to meet demand, given the continued curtailment of Chinese imports, though another closure would send prices higher again.

*

Europe's chief concern has shifted from summer jet fuel to winter heating fuel supplies, as prolonged disruption in the strait and the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict strain the continent's stocks ahead of the winter months.

Crude prices will likely fall as the US and Iran pursue de-escalation. A deal between Iran and the US that would reopen the Strait of Hormuz on an interim basis is likely by mid-September (see: De-escalation likely as US leans toward temporary fix to open strait , 4 August 2026). The continued closure of Hormuz, combined with Houthi disruptions of Saudi oil exports in the Red Sea and Ukrainian strikes against Russian energy infrastructure in the Black Sea, are keeping Brent in a \$75-95 per barrel band.

Expectations of a recovery in Middle East flows will cause prices to fall into a \$65-80 band once a deal is reached. The latent tensions between the US and Iran over the status of the waterway will keep the risk of another crisis—and another closure—relatively high through the rest of 2026.

Markets will absorb the disruptions in the Red Sea and Black Sea. Houthi attacks in the Bab el-Mandeb and Ukrainian attacks on Russian energy in the Black Sea will add upward pressure to prices but likely won't move Brent higher than the \$65-80 band.

Clandestine flows through Hormuz are relieving pressure. Crude transits out of the strait have been averaging 5 million barrels per day (bpd) in August, with the Joint Maritime Information Center estimating "single-digit numbers of tankers in both directions" passing the strait on a daily basis this week.

Hormuz reopening will be partial but sufficient to further ease supply pressure. Uncertainty over the durability of the US-Iran agreement, the continued presence of mines in the main waterway (which will take months to clear), Iranian efforts to extract fees or other concessions from shippers, and the development of alternative routes will keep Hormuz traffic depressed for the rest of 2026. Overall flows are unlikely to exceed 30-50% of the prewar level if a deal is reached—without a deal, flows will remain in an even lower band of 5-15%.

New Hormuz disruptions and a recovery in Chinese imports are factors that could push prices up again. Chinese seaborne crude imports slumped from almost 11 million bpd to just 5 million bpd between February and June. China used its huge inventories to cut its exposure to surging crude prices. Imports in August will return to about 7 million bpd; a full recovery in Chinese imports to pre-war levels and rapid moves by other states to refill strategic inventories could pull prices higher.

A full recovery in Chinese imports, however, is unlikely. China does not publish inventory figures, but Eurasia Group sources have indicated that China can comfortably meet domestic fuel demand for the rest of the year by drawing on stocks if it perceives crude prices to be too costly to ramp up imports (see: Beijing is likely to become the biggest variable in oil pricing , 14 May 2026).

Meanwhile, available global crude volumes are sufficient to meet demand elsewhere, given China's ongoing import restraint.

Product shortages are unlikely in the short term. Fuels inventories improved in June and July following the first, brief US-Iran deal to open the strait. Middle distillate stocks in the US jumped from 101 million barrels in late May to 111 million barrels by late July, within the five-year range. Jet fuel stocks also increased slightly from 45 to 47 million barrels.

Similarly, Asia and Europe don't face imminent shortages, though further disruptions could produce winter difficulties. Overall fuel stocks at the Amsterdam-Rotterdam-Antwerp (ARA) region have slumped from 6 million tons in February to just over 4 million tons in early August, near 10-year lows (though by historical averages, ARA stocks have been bloated over the past decade).

Europe's main concern has flipped from summer jet fuel to winter heating oil supplies. European jet fuel inventories were historically high at the beginning of the year, and despite the decline from almost 1 million tons earlier this year to 576,000 tons in August, there won't be shortages as the peak demand period passes this month. Crucially, jet fuel stocks in Italy (where there were shortages early in the crisis) have stabilized by shifting some spare stocks from other European inventories. The continent's heating oil (known as "gasoil") situation is more concerning. Gasoil stocks at the ARA region are near 10-year lows of 1.5 million tons, down 2.1 million tons since the start of the crisis.

Further disruptions to Hormuz flows, compounded by the ongoing effect of Ukrainian attacks on Russian energy assets in the Black Sea, could put pressure on heating oil inventories heading into winter. A tight market for natural gas (also used for heating) could add to this pressure.

Henning Gloystein
Managing Director, Energy & Resources
+44 (0)73 898 444 98

gloystein@eurasiagroup.net
Gregory Brew
Senior Analyst, Iran & Energy
+1 646 259 3207
brew@eurasiagroup.net
EG Energy, Climate & Resources
ecr@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmsrs2qd1wgy207n7423pru2k

[Opt Out](#) | [Customize Email Preferences](#)